UK SAFETY CAMERA NETWORK LTD

Control Room Operations Policy

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1. Purpose, Scope and Operational Responsibility

1.1 Purpose and scope

This policy establishes the operational requirements governing UK Safety Camera Network Ltd (USCN) control-room monitoring services USCN Live and USCN HighWatch. It applies to personnel undertaking, supervising or managing these services and authorised supporting personnel where their duties affect control-room operations. The separate USCN community CCTV network is expressly excluded. Applicable law, regulatory duties, contractual requirements and lawful customer instructions prevail where mandatory.

1.2 Management responsibility

The Managing Director retains overall accountability for control-room operations and may delegate appropriate operational tasks to competent authorised personnel. Personnel shall act within their authority and refer matters beyond it to an appropriate decision-maker.

1.3 Operator authorisation

Only individually authorised operators may perform monitoring duties. Authorisation shall reflect appropriate competence, training and applicable legally required Security Industry Authority licensing. Access to customers, cameras, systems and functions shall be restricted to authorised duties.

1.4 Contracted monitoring coverage

USCN shall seek continuous staffed coverage during contracted monitoring periods, with suitable handovers and break cover. Unexpected gaps shall be recorded and escalated. Continuous staffing does not require uninterrupted individual viewing of every camera. This is an operational standard, not confirmation that particular arrangements are already deployed.

1.5 Monitoring location

Monitoring shall normally occur at the designated control room. The Managing Director may approve a suitably secure alternative location for continuity, following appropriate assessment and testing where needed. Unauthorised or insecure locations shall not be used.

1.6 Customer service activation

The Managing Director shall authorise monitoring service activation after confirming the relevant customer agreement. Activation must accord with legal and contractual requirements. A comprehensive mandatory activation-readiness checklist is not imposed.

2. Control-Room Equipment and Security

2.1 Physical access

Routine access is limited to the Managing Director and authorised operators. Visitors, contractors and technical personnel may enter only where authorised and appropriately supervised, with CCTV images and confidential information protected. Physical entry does not grant operator system permissions.

2.2 Workstation security

Operators shall manually lock unattended workstations. Automatic inactivity locks shall be used where technically supported and appropriate without disrupting essential monitoring, recording or alerts. Accounts and credentials are governed by Section 6.

2.3 Equipment fault reporting

Apparent equipment faults shall be logged with affected equipment, discovery, impact, actions, responsibility and reported outcome. Critical faults or material monitoring limitations require immediate escalation; other faults shall be prioritised proportionately. Operators do not undertake unauthorised technical diagnosis or repairs.

2.4 Pre-shift checks

Operators shall make basic visual and functional pre-shift checks of applicable video management workstations, displays and telephone facilities, reporting apparent problems. No comprehensive formal checklist is required.

2.5 System changes and maintenance

Significant video management system updates, configuration changes and planned maintenance require Managing Director approval. Disruption should be minimised and resulting faults reported. No comprehensive change register or formal rollback plan is mandatory for every change.

2.6 Additional equipment and connections

External storage devices, additional hardware and new network connections require Managing Director approval and appropriate security controls. Blanket disabling of USB ports is not required.

3. Camera Availability and Fault Detection

3.1 Availability monitoring

Operators shall check camera availability through ordinary monitoring observations and system indications. Automated video-loss or disconnection alerts shall be used where available, configured and tested; this policy does not assume they are deployed.

3.2 Fault severity and escalation

All detected camera failures or material monitoring limitations shall be recorded. Complete monitoring loss, critical camera failure or another material limitation requires immediate escalation. Minor faults may be prioritised by risk and contractual requirements.

3.3 Customer notification

Critical faults or material monitoring limitations shall be communicated promptly to affected customers where appropriate under their agreements. Minor faults may be notified during reasonable contact hours. Significant notifications and attempts shall be recorded.

3.4 Separation of monitoring and technical support

Ordinary operators observe, report, document and escalate apparent faults. Technical diagnosis, restarts, configuration, repairs and technical closure are duties for separately authorised technical personnel, not routine monitoring operators.

3.5 Apparent restoration

When live video visibly returns and is usable for monitoring, the operator shall record apparent availability. This is not technical repair confirmation or formal fault closure. Recurring or intermittent faults shall continue to be escalated as appropriate.

3.6 Partial monitoring failures

Operators shall continue monitoring available cameras where safe and practicable, record material limitations and escalate by risk. They shall not unilaterally change the contracted monitoring scope.

4. Monitoring Procedures and Authorised Viewing

4.1 Authorised customer monitoring

Operators may view assigned customer cameras only for authorised monitoring during contracted periods. Exceptions require appropriate management authorisation or another lawful necessity. Curiosity or personal-interest viewing is prohibited.

4.2 Routine monitoring

Operators shall use professional judgement in selecting and observing authorised live views. No fixed rotation is mandatory, and staffed monitoring does not mean every camera is continuously watched.

4.3 Suspicious activity

Suspicious or unusual activity shall be assessed objectively and proportionately. Significant observations shall be recorded factually, separating what was seen from uncertainty, assumption or allegation. Unjustified discriminatory assumptions shall be avoided and concerns escalated under Section 5.

4.4 Camera controls and zoom

Authorised pan-tilt-zoom and digital zoom may be used routinely with professional judgement, within approved viewing areas, privacy restrictions and customer instructions. Separate permission for each ordinary authorised adjustment is not required.

4.5 Historical footage and disclosure

Ordinary operators have no general permission to browse historical recordings, export footage or release recordings. Requests shall be referred to the Data Protection Officer (DPO), who oversees lawful review, preservation, disclosure and release within USCN controller or processor responsibilities and lawful customer controller instructions. Routine requests are normally handled during scheduled DPO availability. Urgent lawful obligations, emergency communications and protective escalation must not be improperly delayed by DPO absence.

4.6 Shift and operational logs

Basic shift records shall identify relevant operator, period, coverage, handover and significant observations, incidents, faults or escalations. Additional event reports shall be made when appropriate. Routine public activity need not be individually logged without operational justification.

5. Incident Identification and Escalation

5.1 Incident assessment

Operators shall use professional judgement to assess incidents and risks and take proportionate reporting and escalation action. A mandatory three-tier classification is not imposed.

5.2 Emergency services

Operators may contact police, ambulance or fire and rescue services directly whenever professionally justified, without prior management approval. Significant emergency contacts shall be reported to management and recorded.

5.3 Customer notification

Serious incidents, suspected crimes in progress, significant threats and matters requiring customer action shall be communicated promptly where appropriate under agreements. Minor matters may be reported routinely. Significant communications and attempts shall be recorded.

5.4 Factual communications

Communications shall be factual, clear and proportionate, including relevant location, times, observations, risks, actions and material updates. Confirmed observations must be distinguished from uncertainty. No mandatory telephone script is imposed.

5.5 Continued incident observation

Operators should continue observing significant incidents where practicable and provide material updates. They should seek cover or management assistance where incident handling affects other contracted monitoring and escalate material gaps. Operators do not physically intervene or perform technical maintenance as part of monitoring duties.

5.6 Incident records and handover

Records shall capture relevant times, factual observations, actions, contacts and available reference numbers. Unresolved incidents, pending actions and material monitoring concerns shall be handed over. Avoid duplicate records. Historical footage remains subject to DPO oversight.

6. Access Control and Data Protection

6.1 Role-based permissions

Permissions shall be individually assigned, least-privilege and limited to relevant customers, cameras and functions, approved by the Managing Director or authorised delegate. Access shall be reviewed on role change or departure. Historical footage and administration remain separately restricted.

6.2 Accounts and authentication

Use unique accounts where supported, keep credentials confidential and do not share passwords. Use multifactor authentication where supported and appropriate. Unavoidable generic accounts require Managing Director approval, documented justification and compensating accountability controls.

6.3 Confidentiality and personal devices

Unauthorised photography, filming, copying, displaying, discussing or sharing of CCTV images or confidential customer information is prohibited, including recording screens on personal devices. Controlled lawful exceptions require authorisation. There is no blanket mobile-phone possession ban.

6.4 Suspected personal-data breaches

Suspected personal-data breaches, unauthorised access or accidental disclosure shall be promptly reported to the DPO and Managing Director or supervisor without undue delay. Operators shall preserve relevant information but not conduct unauthorised technical investigations. The DPO coordinates assessment and required notifications under applicable controller/processor roles and legal deadlines.

6.5 Customer information

Customer contact information, instructions and operational records shall be used on a need-to-know basis. Legitimate significant disclosures shall be recorded as appropriate. Unnecessary copies and personal retention are prohibited.

6.6 Secure handling and handover

Paper and electronic records shall be secured using approved storage and authorised handover channels; unattended sessions shall be locked. Unauthorised removal or personal retention is prohibited. No comprehensive end-of-shift checklist is mandatory.

7. Service Continuity and Outages

7.1 Monitoring interruptions

Operators shall identify and record apparent interruptions, affected customers and functions, continue unaffected monitoring where practicable and immediately escalate material limitations. Management coordinates technical support and customer communications. Operators do not undertake unauthorised technical troubleshooting.

7.2 Alternative monitoring locations

Managing Director-approved alternative locations require suitable security, equipment and connectivity, assessed and tested as appropriate. Transfers and limitations shall be documented; insecure fallbacks are prohibited. No existing backup control room is presumed.

7.3 Staffing interruptions

Unexpected staffing gaps shall be reported promptly. Management shall seek competent authorised replacement cover where practicable, recording and communicating material gaps. Unqualified cover is prohibited; a permanently assigned standby operator is not required.

7.4 Communications failures

Communications failures shall be recorded and escalated. Suitable authorised alternative methods may be used where available; necessary emergency calls must not be unnecessarily delayed. Management coordinates technical support and customer communication. A permanently installed independent backup telephone is not mandatory.

7.5 Apparent service restoration

Operators shall confirm when live views or monitoring functions visibly return, record apparent resumption time and inform management as appropriate. Technical repair confirmation is separate; no comprehensive restoration checklist is required.

7.6 Outage review

Management shall proportionately review significant or recurring outages, communicate with customers according to agreements and record follow-up. Authorised technical personnel perform technical investigations. Formal root-cause investigation is not mandatory for every minor outage.

8. Training, Testing and Quality Assurance

8.1 Operator competence and initial authorisation

The Managing Director or authorised supervisor shall assess competence, experience, relevant knowledge and understanding before authorising independent monitoring. Induction or instruction shall be provided where necessary. Applicable SIA licensing or other legally mandatory qualifications remain prerequisites. Prior experience alone does not grant access. No standardised mandatory course, written examination or competence certificate is imposed beyond legal requirements.

8.2 Refresher training and operational updates

Risk-based refresher instruction and briefings shall be provided for material system, procedure, legal or customer changes, incidents, weaknesses or performance concerns. Operators shall receive material instructions before new duties. Significant training and briefings shall be recorded proportionately. No fixed annual cycle is imposed.

8.3 Operational testing and emergency exercises

Management may arrange proportionate authorised tests of escalation, communications, continuity and handovers based on risk. Exercises must not disrupt contracted monitoring unnecessarily or cause false emergency-service calls. Significant findings and follow-up shall be recorded. No fixed exercise schedule is required.

8.4 Operator supervision and quality assurance

Risk-based supervision and quality assurance may examine incident records, escalation, procedures, handovers and confidentiality. Management shall provide feedback and proportionate corrective action and record significant findings. Reviews shall be lawful and respect confidentiality. Monthly assessments and continuous performance surveillance are not mandatory.

8.5 Corrective action and operator authorisation

Minor errors may be addressed by coaching; serious or repeated concerns require management escalation. Monitoring permissions may be restricted or suspended where reasonably necessary, with significant decisions recorded and competence reassessed before reinstatement. Operational safeguards are distinct from employment discipline.

8.6 Training, competence and quality-assurance records

Maintain proportionate, secure, restricted records of operator authorisations, qualifications and licences, significant training, concerns, corrective action, restrictions, reassessments, reinstatement and material quality-assurance findings. Retain and dispose of records appropriately. Forms for every routine activity are not mandatory.

9. Records, Accountability and Review

9.1 Operational records and retention

Maintain secure, accurate and relevant records of shifts, incidents, faults, customer and emergency contacts, handovers and significant decisions. Retention shall be risk-based by record type, necessity, legal and contractual duties and preservation requirements, followed by secure disposal. No universal fixed retention period applies. CCTV footage follows separate lawful controller instructions, data-protection requirements and DPO arrangements.

9.2 Management accountability and delegated authority

The Managing Director remains accountable, with proportionate delegation to competent authorised personnel and clear limits. Significant decisions shall be recorded where appropriate; matters beyond authority escalated. DPO responsibilities and technical duties remain distinct. No comprehensive hierarchy or delegation register is mandatory.

9.3 Reporting policy breaches and operational non-compliance

Operators shall report suspected breaches and significant procedural concerns directly to the Managing Director or supervisor, providing relevant facts. Management determines proportionate follow-up. Urgent incident escalation and DPO breach-reporting duties remain in force. No formal investigation, central compliance register or severity framework is mandatory for every concern.

9.4 Management review and operational improvement

Management shall proportionately review significant incidents, recurring failures, material complaints and procedural weaknesses, consider improvements and record significant findings and actions. Technical investigations belong to authorised technical personnel. No fixed review timetable or formal investigation for every minor matter is imposed.

9.5 Policy review and amendment

Review is triggered by material legal, regulatory, service, technology, responsibility or risk changes, or serious concerns. Material amendments require appropriate approval, version control and communication before application. Minor administrative corrections may be managed proportionately. No mandatory annual review applies.

9.6 Policy ownership, approval and commencement

The Managing Director owns and formally approves this policy. It becomes effective on approval unless a later date is expressly specified. Relevant staff shall be informed before affected duties. Approval, publication and operational deployment are separate. Approval does not prove that control-room staffing, systems, backup facilities or customer monitoring are operational or that any customer service has been activated. USCN Live and USCN HighWatch alone are in scope; the community CCTV network is excluded.

Document Control and Formal Approval

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Approval and publication are recorded on the Managing Director's express confirmation. This policy does not itself establish operational readiness, customer activation or any camera-specific authorisation.